Lesson 11: Writing a Persuasive Email

English Stage 1 (B1) · Unit 1: People and Places

Adapted from People and Places - An Intermediate Integrated-Skills Module for English Learners by Sara Ferguson, Grossmont College (CC BY-NC-SA 4.0): 2.9: Assignment: Write a Persuasive Email.

In this lesson

You write a friendly email to a friend or a family member. In the email, you persuade this person to visit you, or to move to a place you know well. You plan your ideas, write the email, and check it with the book's checklist and grade rubric.

Learning goals

After this lesson you should be able to:

- Choose a place and list the things your reader will like about it.
- Write an email with all its parts: email address, subject line, greeting, message and signature line.
- Use a friendly, informal and positive tone for a friend or family member.
- Use at least five positive descriptive adjectives, including one comparative adjective.
- Check your email for commas, capital letters, spelling, adjective word order and simple present verbs.

Key language

Word or phrase	Meaning in simple English	Example
persuade (v)	to give good reasons so that someone agrees to do something	"Persuade them to visit you in a place you know well."
persuasive (adj)	able to make someone agree or act	"Write a persuasive email."
genre	the type of text: an email, a website, a textbook	"Is your genre clear?"
subject line	the short line at the top of an email; it tells the main idea	"It should be short and specific."
greeting	the first words to your reader	"A friendly greeting to your friend or family member."
signature line	your name at the end of the email	"A signature line with your name at the end."
purpose	the reason for writing	"Are you inviting a friend for a vacation or persuading them to move?"
audience	the person or people who read your text	"Is your audience for the email clear?"

Word or phrase	Meaning in simple English	Example
tone	the feeling of a text: positive, friendly, formal, informal	"The tone is positive."
aspect	one part or feature of something	"Make a list of aspects your friend/family member will like about this place."
sights	interesting places that visitors go to see	"It could be the sights, the activities, the weather, festivals or the culture."
comparative adjective	an adjective that compares two things (larger, better)	"Make one of them a comparative adjective to show how much better your place is."

Rules and explanations

The parts of your email (genre)

- **Email address** of your friend or family member. It does not have to be a real address.
- **Subject line**: it tells the main idea of the email. Make it short and specific.
- **Greeting**: friendly, to your friend or family member.
- **Message**: your reasons and details about the place, written to your reader.
- **Signature line**: your name at the end.

Topic, purpose, audience and tone

- **Topic**: your place. It can be a city, a country, a neighborhood or even your house. The place should be obvious.
- **Purpose**: choose one. You invite your reader for a vacation (a visit), or you persuade your reader to move there.
- **Audience and tone**: your reader is a friend or family member, so use a friendly, informal tone. Keep the tone positive.
- Give enough details to "sell" the place: the sights, the activities, the weather, festivals or the culture.

Vocabulary

- Use at least five positive descriptive adjectives. Make one of them comparative, to show how much better your place is.
- Choose different words. The rubric asks for word choice that is "varied and not repetitive".
- Use phrases from the mentor texts of this unit, for example from "Welcome to East County" (Lesson 8): "The area offers ...", "Spend an afternoon ...", "Don't miss ...", "... is famous for ...".

Grammar checklist

- **Compound sentences**: a comma before the FANBOYS word (and, but, or, so). A period at the end of every sentence.
- **Capitalization**: the first word of every sentence, and names of people and places.
- **Spelling**, especially the vocabulary words from this chapter.

- **Adjective + noun word order**: the adjective comes before the noun: "sparkling lakes", not "lakes sparkling".
- **Simple present verb form**: after he, she, it or one thing, add -s: "The area offers ...".
- **Comparatives**: one-syllable adjective + -er + than ("larger than"); most longer adjectives: more + adjective + than ("more beautiful than").

> **Note for Arabic speakers**
>
> - In Arabic, the adjective usually comes after the noun. In English, it comes before the noun: "a beautiful beach", not "a beach beautiful".
> - Arabic has no capital letters, so check them carefully: the first word of each sentence, and names of people, cities, countries, nationalities and languages.

Practice

1. Choose your place. Make a list of places you know well: a city, country, neighborhood or even your house. Choose the nicest place on your list.

2. What will your reader like? Make a list of aspects your friend or family member will like about this place: the sights, the activities, the weather, festivals or the culture. Write at least five things.

3. Choose your purpose. Will you persuade your reader to visit or to move? Complete: "I want to persuade my _____ to _____ _____."

4. Collect adjectives. Write five positive descriptive adjectives for your place, each with a noun (adjective + noun). Then write one sentence with a comparative adjective and "than".

5. Write the frame. Write (a) an email address, (b) a short and specific subject line, (c) a friendly greeting and (d) a signature line.

6. Say it first. Speak for one minute: why should your friend come to your place? Say it to your tutor, or record yourself with your phone and listen back.

7. Write and check. Write your email (see Writing task). Check every point in Rules and explanations above (the book's Writing Checklist). Then give your email points for each part of the book's grade rubric: Content; Genre, audience and purpose; Vocabulary; Grammar and mechanics. Ask your tutor to grade it too, and compare.

Speak with your tutor

- "I want to persuade you to visit my city. Be a friend who is not sure. Ask me questions, one at a time, and I will give you reasons."
- "Now I want to persuade you to move to my city. When I finish, tell me which reason was the most persuasive, and why."
- "Ask me about the sights, activities, weather, festivals and culture of my place. After each answer, suggest one better adjective."

- "I will read my email aloud. Tell me: is the tone friendly, informal and positive? Is the purpose clear?"
- "Check my adjective + noun word order and my comparative adjectives. Correct my mistakes one by one."

Read aloud

- per·SUADE: I want to persuade you to visit me.
- per·SUA·sive
- de·SCRIP·tive
- AD·jec·tive
- com·PAR·a·tive
- POS·i·tive
- in·FOR·mal
- PUR·pose
- AU·di·ence
- SIG·na·ture

Writing task

Write a persuasive email. Choose one prompt:

- Write an email to a friend or family member. Persuade them to visit you in a place you know well.
- Write to a friend or family member. Persuade them to move to a place you know well.

Requirements:

- All the parts of an email: email address, subject line, friendly greeting, message and signature line.
- A clear topic (your place), a clear purpose (a visit or a move), and a friendly, informal and positive tone.
- At least five positive descriptive adjectives; at least one of them is comparative.
- Length: the book gives no word limit. Write enough details to "sell" the place.

Before you finish, use the Grammar checklist. Then read your email to your tutor (or type it) and ask for a grade with the four rubric criteria.

Answer key

1-3. (example answer) 1. San Diego, my neighborhood, my parents' house: I choose San Diego. 2. The beaches, the zoo, Balboa Park, the warm weather, the food. 3. I want to persuade my friend Sami to visit San Diego.

4. (example answer) warm weather, beautiful beaches, a famous zoo, a large park, delicious food. "In summer, the weather in San Diego is more pleasant than the weather in our hometown."

5. (example answer) (a) sami.friend@email.com (b) Come and visit me in San Diego this summer! (c) Hi Sami, (d) Your friend, Huda

6. Your own answer.

7. (example answer) This model has all the parts, a positive tone, more than five positive adjectives (warm, sunny, beautiful, soft, famous, delicious, friendly, perfect) and a comparative (more pleasant than).

> To: sami.friend@email.com
>
> Subject: Come and visit me in San Diego this summer!
>
> Hi Sami,
>
> How are you? I want to invite you to visit me in San Diego this summer. I know you will love it here!
>
> San Diego has warm, sunny weather, and the beaches are beautiful. Spend an afternoon swimming in the ocean or relaxing on the soft sand. Don't miss the famous zoo and Balboa Park. The food here is delicious, and the people are friendly. In summer, the weather in San Diego is more pleasant than the weather in our hometown, so it is the perfect time for a visit.
>
> You can stay in my apartment. Please come soon!
>
> Your friend,
>
> Huda

My notes